MS EXCEL · UNIT 5

Basic Formatting

Font, number format, shortcuts, borders and fill colour

8	8	5	1
Topics	Practices	Number shortcuts	Student Results sheet

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Formatting in Excel vs Word

5.1 · Theory

Word formatting

- Bold, Italic, Underline
- Font size & colour
- Paragraph spacing
- Page margins

FORMATS TEXT AND PARAGRAPHS

Excel formatting

- Bold, Italic, Underline (same as Word)
- Font size & colour (same as Word)
- **Number Format — unique to Excel**
- Cell borders & fill colour

FORMATS CELLS, NUMBERS & STRUCTURE

TIP

Select the cell(s) FIRST, then apply formatting — exactly the same rule as in Word.

Practice 5.1: Set up the sheet

Practice · 1 of 8

GOAL

Type the data for the Student Results sheet.

1. In `A1` to `E1` type: `Name`, `Score`, `Grade %`, `Amount`, `Status`.
2. Type the 5 students in rows 2–6 (see the table).
3. Click `A7`. Type `Total` → Enter.

Name	Score	Grade %	Amount	Status
Ahmed Ali	1450	0.85	5000	Pass
Sara Khan	1820	0.92	7500	Pass
Bilal Raza	1230	0.78	4200	Pass
Zara Mir	980	0.62	3100	Fail
Omar Butt	1640	0.88	6300	Pass

Plain digits only — no commas, no Rs.

Numbers align RIGHT. Text aligns LEFT.

Font formatting

5.2 · Theory

Format	Shortcut	Use in Excel
Bold	`Ctrl + B`	Header rows, totals, important values
Italic	`Ctrl + I`	Notes, secondary information
Underline	`Ctrl + U`	Column headers, titles
Font Size	—	Headers: 12–14 pt. Data: 10–11 pt.
Font Colour	—	Colour-code different categories of data
Fill Colour	—	Background colour of the cell (not the text)

HOME TAB → FONT GROUP

B Bold · I Italic · U Underline · A Font Colour · Fill Colour

Practice 5.2: Font formatting

Practice · 2 of 8

GOAL

Make the header, the Total and a note stand out.

1. Select `A1:E1`. Press `Ctrl+B`.
2. Set the Font Size to `12`.
3. Click `A7`. Press `Ctrl+B`.
4. Click `A9`. Press `Ctrl+I`.
5. Type `Source: class register` → Enter.
6. Click `A9`. Try `Ctrl+U`, then press it again.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- Header row is bold and bigger
- Total is bold
- The note in A9 is italic

Alignment, wrap text and merge

5.3 · Theory

Tool	How to use it	What it does
Left / Centre / Right	Select the cells → Home → Alignment group → click the button	Moves the content inside the cell. Text starts on the left and numbers on the right — change it when you want.
Wrap Text	Select the cells → Home → Alignment group → Wrap Text	Long text breaks into lines inside the cell and the row grows taller.
Merge & Centre	Select the cells → Home → Alignment group → Merge & Centre	Joins the cells into one and centres the text. Used for titles.
Unmerge	Click the merged cell → click Merge & Centre again	Splits it back into separate cells.

MERGE WARNING

Type your text in the first cell BEFORE merging. If several selected cells have content, Excel keeps only the top-left one.

Practice 5.3: Alignment

Practice · 3 of 8

GOAL

Align headers, wrap a long note and merge a title.

1. Select **A1:E1**. Click **Centre** in the Alignment group.
2. Select **E2:E6**. Click **Centre**.
3. In **G2** type **Passed all subjects with good marks**.
4. With **G2** selected, click **Wrap Text**.
5. In **A9** type **Student Results**.
6. Select **A9:E9** → **Merge & Centre**.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- Headers and Status are centred
- G2 wraps onto several lines
- The row grew taller by itself
- A9:E9 is one merged cell

Number format

5.4 · Theory

Controls HOW a number is displayed — without changing the value stored in the cell.

Format	Looks like	When to use
General	`1234.56`	Default — raw numbers, no special formatting
Number	`1,234.56`	Any general numeric data
Currency	`Rs. 1,234.56`	Money amounts
Accounting	`Rs. 1,234.56`	Financial statements — aligns the symbol
Percentage	`85.00%`	Scores, proportions, rates
Date	`05/04/2026`	Date values — many display options
Time	`14:30 or 2:30 PM`	Time values
Text	`001234`	IDs, phone numbers, codes with leading zeros

How to apply: select cells → Home → Number group → dropdown → choose a format. Or press `Ctrl + 1` for all options.

Practice 5.4: Apply number formats

GOAL

Change how the numbers look — not the value stored in the cell.

1. Select **B2:B6**. Home → Number box → **Number**.
2. Select **C2:C6** → **Percentage**.
3. Click **D7**. Type **26100** → Enter.
4. Select **D2:D7** → **Currency**.
5. Click **B2**. Look at the Formula Bar.

YOU SHOULD SEE

1450	→ **1450.00**
0.85	→ **85.00%**
5000	→ **Rs. 5,000.00**

- Formula Bar still shows 1450

Number format shortcuts

5.5 · Theory

Ctrl + Shift + 1	Number format	1,234.00	
Ctrl + Shift + 2	Time format	2:30 PM	
Ctrl + Shift + 3	Date format	5-Apr-26	
Ctrl + Shift + 4	Currency format	Rs. 1,234.56	
Ctrl + Shift + 5	Percentage format	85.00%	
Ctrl + 1	Format Cells dialog	All options	

Number Format only changes how the number looks — the stored value never changes.

Practice 5.5: Shortcuts and Ctrl+1

Practice · 5 of 8

GOAL

Use shortcuts and the Format Cells dialog.

1. Select `B2:B6`. Press `Ctrl+Shift+1`.
2. Click `C3`. Press `Ctrl+1`.
3. Look at the Number tab. Press `Esc`.
4. Click `D5`. Press `Ctrl+1` → `Accounting` → OK.
5. Press `Ctrl+Z` to undo.

YOU SHOULD SEE

1450.00 → **1,450.00**

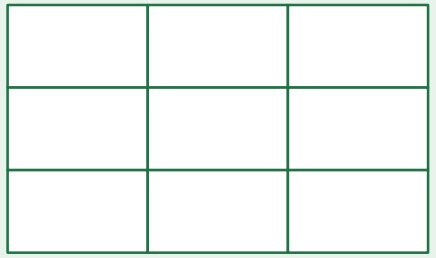
- C3 is Percentage, 2 decimals
- Accounting moves Rs. to the left edge

Borders

5.6 · Theory

Borders are lines drawn around cells — making tables look structured and professional.

1. Select cells → Home → Font group → Borders dropdown → choose a preset
2. For custom borders: Ctrl + 1 → Border tab → choose line style, colour and sides



All Borders

Lines around every cell



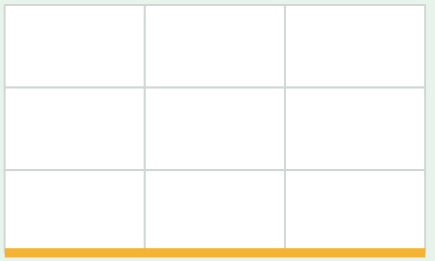
Outside Borders

Line around the outer edge only



Thick Box Border

Bold outer border



Bottom Border

Underline the selected row

TIP

Use All Borders for data rows and Thick Box Border for the outer edge — instantly professional tables.

Practice 5.6: Apply borders

Practice · 6 of 8

GOAL

Add borders to the whole table.

1. Select `A1:E7`.
2. Home → Borders dropdown → `All Borders`.
3. Borders dropdown → `Thick Box Border`.
4. Select `A1:E1`.
5. Borders dropdown → `Bottom Border`.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- Thin lines inside the table
- Thick frame around the outside
- Stronger line under the header

Fill colour — background colour

5.7 · Theory

Select cells → Home → Font group → Fill Colour dropdown → choose a colour

To remove fill: select cells → Fill Colour → No Fill

Use case	Preview	Why / how it looks
Header row	**Abc**	Dark green fill with white bold text — stands out clearly
Total row	**Abc**	Light yellow fill with bold text — signals a summary
Alternating rows (1)	**Abc**	White — clean and readable
Alternating rows (2)	**Abc**	Very light blue — subtle alternation for long tables
Warning / Error	**Abc**	Red tint — highlights missing data or errors
Good / Pass	**Abc**	Light green — positive result or passed condition

Practice 5.7: Fill colour

GOAL

Colour the header, total and status cells.

1. Select `A1:E1`. Fill Colour → `Dark Green`.
2. Font Colour → `White`.
3. Select `A7:E7` → `Light Yellow`.
4. Click `E4` → `Red tint`.
5. Hold `Ctrl`. Select `E2`, `E3`, `E5`, `E6` → `Light Green`.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- Green header with white text
- Yellow Total row
- Fail is red, Pass is green
- Compare with the next slides

Format Painter

5.8 · Theory

Copy formatting from one cell to others — without copying the content.

1

1 · Select the formatted cell

Click the cell that already has the format you want.

2

2 · Click Format Painter

Home tab → Clipboard group → the paintbrush. The pointer gets a brush.

3

3 · Paint the target

Click or drag over the cells to format. Double-click the brush to paint several places; press Esc to stop.

REMEMBER

Format Painter copies only the formatting — never the content.

It copies: font, size, colour, fill colour, borders, number format and alignment.

Practice 5.8: Format Painter

Practice · 8 of 8

GOAL

Copy the header format onto a new header cell.

1. Type **Remarks** in **G1**.
2. Click **A1** (your formatted header).
3. On the Home tab, click **Format Painter**.
4. Click **G1**.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- G1 now matches A1: bold, dark green, white text
- The text Remarks did not change
- Only the formatting was copied

Unit 5 — Key takeaways

5.1	Excel has all Word font formatting — plus Number Format, which is unique to spreadsheets.
5.2	Bold, Italic and Underline work like Word — select the cells first, then format.
5.3	Align content with the Alignment group. Type text before Merge & Centre. Wrap Text keeps long text in one cell.
5.4	Number Format changes how a number looks, never the value stored in the cell.
5.5	Ctrl+Shift+4 = Currency, Ctrl+Shift+5 = Percentage, Ctrl+1 = Format Cells dialog.
5.6	Borders make tables readable — All Borders for data, Thick Box for the outer edge.
5.7	Fill Colour codes information — green headers, yellow totals, red for warnings.
5.8	Format Painter copies formatting (not content) from one cell to others.

Your completed Student Results sheet

Result

Built step by step in Practices 5.1 to 5.8 — every Unit 5 skill in one sheet.

Name	Score	Grade %	Amount	Status	Remarks
Ahmed Ali Khan	1,450.00	85.00%	Rs. 5,000.00	Pass	Passed all subjects with good marks
Sara Khan	1,820.00	92.00%	Rs. 7,500.00	Pass	
Bilal Raza	1,230.00	78.00%	Rs. 4,200.00	Pass	
Zara Mir	980.00	62.00%	Rs. 3,100.00	Fail	
Omar Butt	1,640.00	88.00%	Rs. 6,300.00	Pass	
Total			**Rs. 26,100.00**		

CHECK YOUR WORK

Centred headers and Status • number formats • borders • green, yellow and red fills • Remarks header painted from A1 • merged title in row 9.